

Claude Workflows Explained

FRONTMATTER

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REFERENCE VIDEOS

- CLAUDE CODE FULL COURSE 4 HOURS: Build & Sell (2026) (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QoQBzR1NIql>) -- Nick Saraev -- Watch the workflow and pipeline sections: how Nick chains Claude Code tasks into a repeatable build process
- "I built 500+ AI agents, here's everything I know" (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Svp7fbF0g2l>) -- Nate Herk -- Watch for how Nate thinks about breaking work into agent steps vs single prompts
- Stop Vibe Coding: Context Engineering & RAG for AI Agents (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7zZtxUW6dhc>) -- Cole Medin -- Watch for how structured workflow thinking differs from one-shot prompting

THE ONE THING

A Claude workflow is a sequence of focused tasks that each do one thing well -- the shift from prompting to building is just learning to break work into those steps.

HOOK

Everyone starts with Claude by asking it questions. At some point you realise you are building something. Here is the difference -- and how to make the shift.

TARGET VIEWER

Someone who uses Claude well for one-off tasks but has never thought about chaining steps together -- they want to automate something but do not know how to structure it.

PAYOFF

After watching, the viewer can take any repetitive task they currently do manually and break it into Claude workflow steps -- and understand which parts Claude runs and which parts they control.

BEAT STRUCTURE

Beat -- The Prompting Ceiling

Point: Prompting one task at a time has a ceiling -- you can only go so far before the complexity outgrows a single prompt. Workflows break that ceiling.

Visual: Split screen: one large complex prompt with a mediocre output vs the same task broken into three focused steps with a much better final result

Target words: ~110w

Beat -- What a Workflow Is

Point: A workflow is a defined sequence of Claude tasks where the output of one step becomes the input to the next. No magic -- just structure applied to a repeatable process.

Visual: Diagram: three boxes connected by arrows -- Step 1 output feeds Step 2, Step 2 output feeds Step 3 -- concrete example underneath each box

Target words: ~160w

Beat -- Human Steps vs Claude Steps

Point: Not every step in a workflow is automated. Some steps are Claude. Some are you reviewing or approving. Knowing which is which is the design decision.

Visual: Workflow diagram with colour coding: blue = Claude runs, orange = human reviews -- show a content pipeline example with both colours

Target words: ~170w

Beat -- The Sub-Agent Pattern

Point: For complex workflows, you can spin up Claude instances as sub-agents -- each one handles a single specialised task. This is how large automated systems are built.

Visual: Terminal: main Claude instance spawning sub-agents for research, writing, and formatting -- each completing its task and returning output to the main agent

Target words: ~180w

Beat -- Building Your First Workflow

Point: Pick one thing you do repeatedly: research and summarise, draft and review, collect and format. Map the steps. Assign each to Claude or human. Run it once manually, then automate.

Visual: Live demo: map a simple research workflow on a whiteboard-style diagram, then execute step one in terminal

Target words: ~150w

Beat -- CTA Bridge

Point: Workflows depend on context -- the next video explains context windows: why Claude forgets things mid-workflow and how to design around it.

Visual: Preview clip from Context Windows Explained

Target words: ~60w

ANALOGY BANK

- Workflow vs single prompt: Like the difference between asking someone to 'write a report' vs giving them a structured brief with a research phase, a drafting phase, and a review phase -- same goal, completely different quality ceiling.

- Sub-agents: Like a small team where each person specialises -- a researcher, a writer, an editor -- rather than one person doing everything. Each is better at their specific task than any generalist would be.

THESIS LINE LOCATION

Beat 2 -- The insight is: a workflow is not magic, it is structure -- and once you see work as a sequence of focused steps rather than one big task, you can automate almost anything.

FRAMEWORK PHRASE

Steps, not prompts

SPECIFICITY BANK

- Claude Code supports sub-agent spawning from a main agent session
- Workflow steps can be: bash commands, file reads/writes, API calls, human review checkpoints
- CLAUDE.md can define workflow conventions for a project
- Claude Code hooks can trigger automated steps at specific workflow events

CONSTRAINTS

- Do not go into n8n, Make, or other automation platforms -- keep it Claude-native
- Do not explain context windows or token limits -- those are the next two videos
- Keep it conceptual -- this is the "what is a workflow" video, not a tutorial on building one
- Do not explain MCP servers or API integrations -- those are later

CTA DIRECTION

Workflows depend on context -- the next video explains context windows: why Claude forgets things mid-workflow and the practical workarounds that keep your workflows on track.

PERSONAL ANGLE [DANIEL TO FILL]

Suggested: The first time you built a multi-step Claude workflow that ran without you touching it -- what the task was and what it replaced.

VULNERABILITY MOMENT [DANIEL TO FILL]

Suggested: A workflow that broke because you tried to do too much in one step -- and how breaking it into smaller focused steps fixed it immediately.

Note: belongs in Beat 1